



## English — Cbse English — Combined Half-Yearly (40 Marks)

### ANSWER KEY — FOR GRADING

Subject: English | Class: Class 9

Total Marks: 40 | Time Allowed: 1h 30m | CBSE

#### General Instructions:

1. The paper has four sections: A (Reading), B (Writing), C (Grammar), D (Literature).
2. Sections A-C assess language skills; Section D assesses the prescribed textbook.
3. Attempt all sections. Internal choice is provided in the Writing section.

| Q.NO.                                                                           | QUESTIONS | MARKS |
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| <b>Section A — Reading</b><br>Attempt all 1 questions. Each carries 10 mark(s). |           |       |



| Q.NO. | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MARKS |
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| 1     | <p><i>Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.</i></p> <p><b>How Much Water a City Drinks</b></p> <p>Urban water demand is rising rapidly as populations swell and lifestyles shift. According to a 2021 report by the Central Ground Water Board, the average urban Indian consumes roughly 135 litres of water per day. This figure, however, masks significant variation across income groups and regions.</p> <p>Where does all this water go? A substantial portion is used for domestic chores. Bathing and washing account for nearly 40% of household water use, while toilet flushing alone consumes about 20%. Drinking and cooking represent a mere 5%, and the remaining 35% is distributed across cleaning, gardening, and incidental wastage.</p> <p>The environmental toll of this consumption is immense. Supplying 135 litres daily to a city of ten million people requires over 1.35 billion litres of treated water each day. Treating and pumping this water demands enormous energy, contributing to carbon emissions. Furthermore, much of the water drawn from groundwater aquifers is not replenished, leading to declining water tables. In Delhi, groundwater levels fell by an alarming 0.5 metres per year between 2012 and 2022.</p> <p>Sustainable urban living requires a shift in both behaviour and infrastructure. Rainwater harvesting, wastewater recycling, and fixing leaky pipes can drastically reduce the strain on municipal supplies. If every household recycled just 50% of its bathing water for flushing, a city could save millions of litres daily. Ultimately, understanding where our water goes is the first step toward ensuring that our cities do not run dry.</p> <p>(i) According to the 2021 report mentioned in the passage, what is the approximate daily water consumption of an average urban Indian? [2 mark(s)]<br/> (A) 50 litres<br/> (B) 1.35 billion litres<br/> (C) 135 litres<br/> (D) 0.5 litres<br/> <b>Ans: C</b><br/> <i>The first paragraph explicitly states that the average urban Indian consumes roughly 135 litres of water per day according to the 2021 report.</i></p> <p>(ii) Based on the passage, which combination of household activities accounts for 60% of daily water use? [2 mark(s)]<br/> (A) Drinking and cooking<br/> (B) Bathing/washing and toilet flushing<br/> (C) Cleaning and gardening<br/> (D) Incidental wastage and gardening<br/> <b>Ans: B</b><br/> <i>The passage states that bathing and washing account for 40% of water use, and toilet flushing consumes 20%, which together make up 60% of household water use.</i></p> | 10    |



| Q.NO.                                                                     | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MARKS |
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|                                                                           | <p>(iii) Why does the author state that supplying water to a large city has an "immense" environmental toll? [2 mark(s)]<br/> <b>Ans:</b> Because treating and pumping billions of litres of water demands enormous energy, which contributes to carbon emissions and depletes groundwater aquifers. <i>The passage explains that the immense environmental toll is due to the enormous energy required for treating and pumping water, leading to carbon emissions, and the depletion of un-replenished groundwater aquifers.</i></p> <p>(iv) Which word in the first paragraph means "hides" or "covers up"? [2 mark(s)]<br/> (A) masks<br/> (B) swell<br/> (C) distributed<br/> (D) consumes<br/> <b>Ans:</b> A<br/> <i>In the context of the sentence 'This figure, however, masks significant variation', the word 'masks' means to hide or cover up the true extent of the variation.</i></p> <p>(v) What is the main takeaway from the passage regarding urban water usage? [2 mark(s)]<br/> <b>Ans:</b> Understanding water usage is the first step toward sustainable water management, which involves recycling and harvesting to prevent cities from running dry. <i>The concluding paragraph emphasizes that understanding water usage is essential for sustainable urban living, highlighting that actions like recycling and harvesting are needed to ensure cities do not run dry.</i></p> |       |
| <p align="center"><b>Section B — Writing</b><br/> Attempt 1 out of 1.</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |       |



| Q.NO. | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MARKS |
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| 2     | <p><b>Notice</b></p> <p>You are Vikram Singh, the Cultural Secretary of Sacred Heart School, Lucknow. The school's Annual Day function is scheduled for late November 2024. Rehearsals for various events — dance, music, and drama — need to begin soon. Draft a notice (60–90 words) informing all participating students about the rehearsal schedule, including dates, timings, venue, what to bring, and attendance requirements. Ensure the notice is formal and complete.</p> <p><i>(Word limit: 60–90 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i></p> <p><b>Model Answer: NOTICE</b></p> <p>Sacred Heart School, Lucknow</p> <p>Annual Day Rehearsal Schedule</p> <p>20 October 2024</p> <p>All students participating in the school Annual Day function are informed that rehearsals will commence from 25 October 2024 in the school auditorium. Dance and music participants must report at 3:30 pm, while drama participants should arrive at 4:30 pm. Rehearsals will be held on all weekdays except Wednesdays. Participants are advised to carry their props and wear comfortable clothing. Those unable to attend on any day must inform the undersigned in advance with a valid reason. Regular attendance is essential for a polished performance.</p> <p>Vikram Singh<br/>Cultural Secretary</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Rehearsals commence from 25 October 2024 in the school auditorium</li> <li>• Dance and music participants report at 3:30 pm; drama participants at 4:30 pm</li> <li>• Rehearsals held on all weekdays except Wednesdays</li> <li>• Participants must carry props and wear comfortable clothing</li> <li>• Those unable to attend must inform the undersigned in advance with a valid reason</li> <li>• Regular attendance emphasised as essential for a polished performance</li> <li>• Format: 1 mark(s)</li> <li>• Content: 2 mark(s)</li> <li>• Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s)</li> <li>• Spelling &amp; Grammar: 1 mark(s)</li> </ul> <p><b>OR</b></p> <p><b>Informal Letter</b></p> <p>You are Saanvi/Samar, a Class 9 student living at 8, Maple Avenue, Shimla. Your close friend Nitya/Nikhil, who lives in Delhi, has always encouraged your interest in science. You recently won the first prize at an inter-school science exhibition for your working model on rainwater harvesting. Write a letter to Nitya/Nikhil sharing this exciting news. In your letter, you should:</p> | 5     |



| Q.NO.                                                                                                                   | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MARKS |
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|                                                                                                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• mention what the exhibition was, where it was held, and how many schools participated</li> <li>• describe your model and how you felt when your name was announced as the winner</li> <li>• invite your friend to visit Shimla during the winter break so you can celebrate together</li> </ul> <p><i>(Word limit: 100–150 words; Suggested time: 20 min)</i></p> <p><b>Model Answer:</b> 8, Maple Avenue<br/>Shimla</p> <p>20 November 2024</p> <p>Dear Nitya,</p> <p>I hope you are doing great! I have some wonderful news to share with you. Last week, our school hosted the annual inter-school science exhibition, and I participated with a working model on rainwater harvesting. There were over forty entries from twelve schools, so the competition was really tough.</p> <p>When the chief guest announced the first prize, I could not believe my ears — my name was called! Our principal congratulated me on stage, and my parents were beaming with pride. All those late nights of building the model finally paid off.</p> <p>I really wish you had been there to cheer for me. Why don't you come to Shimla during the winter break? We can celebrate together, explore the snow, and have a great time. Do ask your parents and let me know soon.</p> <p>Can't wait to hear from you!</p> <p>Yours lovingly,<br/>Saanvi</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Won first prize at an inter-school science exhibition with a working model on rainwater harvesting</li> <li>• Describe feelings when name was announced and mention parents' or principal's pride</li> <li>• Invite friend to visit Shimla during the winter break to celebrate together</li> <li>• Format: 1 mark(s)</li> <li>• Content: 2 mark(s)</li> <li>• Organisation/Expression: 1 mark(s)</li> <li>• Spelling &amp; Grammar: 1 mark(s)</li> </ul> |       |
| <p align="center"><b>Section C — Grammar</b></p> <p align="center">Attempt all 5 questions. Each carries 1 mark(s).</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |       |



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| 3     | <p>___ by ambition, the young entrepreneur worked day and night to establish her startup in the highly competitive market. [Participles &amp; Gerunds]</p> <p>(A) Driving<br/>(B) Driven<br/>(C) Having driving<br/>(D) Drives</p> <p><b>Answer: Correct Option: (B)</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The past participle 'Driven' begins a participial phrase that modifies the subject 'the young entrepreneur', indicating she was motivated by ambition. 'Driving' is a present participle suggesting she was doing the driving rather than being driven, 'having driving' is ungrammatical, and 'drives' is a finite verb that cannot introduce a participial phrase.</p> | 1     |
| 4     | <p>Bad weather prevented us from ___ the journey, forcing us to stay back at the inn. [Participles &amp; Gerunds]</p> <p>(A) resume<br/>(B) to resume<br/>(C) resumed<br/>(D) resuming</p> <p><b>Answer: Correct Option: (D)</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> After the preposition 'from', the verb form must be a gerund. 'Resuming' is the correct gerund acting as the object of the preposition 'from'. 'Resume', 'to resume', and 'resumed' are all non-gerund forms that cannot follow a preposition.</p>                                                                                                                                                               | 1     |
| 5     | <p>The scientist conducted the experiment ___ to ensure accurate results. [Adverbs]</p> <p>(A) careful<br/>(B) carefully<br/>(C) care<br/>(D) caring</p> <p><b>Answer: Correct Option: (B)</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> An adverb of manner describes how an action is performed and typically ends in '-ly'. 'Carefully' modifies the verb 'conducted' by answering 'How?'. 'Careful' is an adjective, 'care' is a noun, and 'caring' is a participle/adjective — none of these can modify a verb.</p>                                                                                                                                                                    | 1     |
| 6     | <p>___ the weather improve, the match will resume after lunch. [Conditionals]</p> <p>(A) Should<br/>(B) Had<br/>(C) Were<br/>(D) Did</p> <p><b>Answer: Correct Option: (A)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 1     |



| Q.NO.                                                                                                                  | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | MARKS |
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|                                                                                                                        | <p>► <b>Why?</b> In formal English, 'if' can be dropped from a first conditional by inverting the subject and 'should': 'Should the weather improve' means 'If the weather should improve.' 'Had' is used for third conditional inversion, 'Were' for second conditional inversion, and 'Did' is not a valid inversion auxiliary for conditionals.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |       |
| 7                                                                                                                      | <p>Several traditional industries are struggling to survive; ____, the handmade textile sector has seen a remarkable revival due to growing demand for sustainable products. [Conjunctions]</p> <p>(A) therefore<br/>(B) consequently<br/>(C) similarly<br/>(D) however</p> <p><b>Answer: Correct Option: (D)</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The sentence presents a contrast: while most traditional industries struggle, the handmade textile sector is reviving. 'However' is the adversative conjunctive adverb that signals this unexpected contrast, correctly punctuated with a semicolon before it and a comma after it. 'Therefore' and 'consequently' both indicate result rather than contrast, and 'similarly' would suggest parallel situations rather than opposition.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 1     |
| <p style="text-align: center;"><b>Section D – Literature</b><br/>Attempt all 10 questions. Each carries 2 mark(s).</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |       |
| 8                                                                                                                      | <p>A painter is compared to a gardener because ____.</p> <p><b>Answer: A painter is compared to a gardener because both are artists who bring vibrant hues and creative visions to life. Just as a painter uses brushstrokes on a canvas to create a painting, a gardener uses seeds on a plot of earth to cultivate a garden.</b></p> <p><b>The comparison highlights that both individuals transform their mediums into beautiful artworks. In the hands of a gardener, "Gardens become paintings still," demonstrating that art and life coincide in their work. Both carefully plant their visions, whether in soil or on canvas, to create something ever new.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The poem draws a parallel between the act of painting and the act of gardening. The poet uses metaphors where the earth is the palette, seeds are the brushstrokes, and the plot is the canvas. Therefore, just as a painter creates art on a canvas with brushstrokes, a gardener creates art in a garden with seeds, making the gardener an artist of nature.</p> <p>[Ch 6: Canvas of Soil]</p> | 2     |
| 9                                                                                                                      | <p>The phrase 'standing ovation' is an example of an adjective-noun collocation. Identify two other similar examples from the poem.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2     |



| Q.NO. | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | MARKS |
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|       | <p>Answer: <b>Two examples of adjective-noun collocations from the poem are gold medals and beaming faces.</b></p> <p><b>In the phrase gold medals, the word 'gold' acts as an adjective modifying the noun 'medals', indicating the type or colour of the medals. Similarly, in beaming faces, the present participle 'beaming' functions as an adjective describing the noun 'faces', showing the athletes' joy.</b></p> <p><b>Other valid examples from the poem include young boy and Special Olympics. In young boy, the adjective 'young' describes the noun 'boy', and in Special Olympics, the adjective 'Special' modifies the proper noun 'Olympics'.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> An adjective-noun collocation is a pair of words where an adjective habitually modifies a noun. In the poem's final stanza, 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces' perfectly fit this criterion, as 'gold' describes the medals and 'beaming' describes the faces. Other acceptable pairs from the provided text include 'young boy' and 'Special Olympics'.</p> <p>► <b>Step-by-step:</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Step 1: Understand that an adjective-noun collocation consists of an adjective modifying a noun that habitually appears together.</li> <li>2. Step 2: Scan the poem lines provided in the context for adjective-noun pairs (e.g., in the line 'with nine gold medals' and 'nine beaming faces').</li> <li>3. Step 3: Identify two clear examples, such as 'gold medals' and 'beaming faces', and explain how the adjective modifies the noun in each pair.</li> </ol> <p>[Ch 10: Nine Gold Medals]</p>                                              |       |
| 10    | <p>Do you think Onula's support helped Sentila? If yes, why? If no, why not?</p> <p>Answer: <b>Yes, Onula's support definitely helped Sentila. Initially, Sentila was too tense while making pots, causing the clay to not yield the right shape and leaving her frustrated.</b></p> <p><b>Onula helped by offering to teach her and demonstrating how to make a perfect pot. Following Onula's instructions gave Sentila a confidence she had never felt before, allowing her to successfully create a beautiful pot. Additionally, Onula gave her constructive advice on shaping the mouth of the pot, encouraging her to watch her mother carefully, which further supported her learning.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The context clearly shows that Sentila was failing to learn pot-making from her mother for almost a year due to tension. Onula noticed this tension and intervened. By demonstrating the process and offering encouraging words, Onula instilled confidence in Sentila, which directly resulted in Sentila successfully making a pot. Onula's further advice also provided a clear path for improvement, proving her support was vital.</p> <p>► <b>Step-by-step:</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Step 1: Identify that Sentila was struggling and too tense before Onula's help.</li> <li>2. Step 2: Note that Onula offered to teach her and demonstrated making a perfect pot.</li> <li>3. Step 3: Highlight that Onula's instructions gave Sentila confidence, leading to her success.</li> <li>4. Step 4: Mention Onula's additional advice on shaping the pot's mouth as further support.</li> </ol> <p>[Ch 3: The Pot Maker]</p> | 2     |



| Q.NO. | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MARKS |
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| 11    | <p>The poet uses a metaphor in the line, 'The first step is the hardest'. Explain why this is metaphorical.</p> <p><b>Answer: The line 'The first step is the hardest' is metaphorical because the first step does not refer to a literal physical movement. Instead, it symbolises the initial resolve required to begin the journey of personal development.</b></p> <p><b>Taking this step represents breaking away from the comfort zone of the status quo and overcoming the fear of change. The metaphor highlights that making the initial choice to step into the future is the most difficult part of growth, requiring one to believe in themselves to move forward.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The textbook context explicitly states that 'The first step symbolises the initial [effort] required to begin the journey of [change] or personal development.' A metaphor works by using a concrete image (a step) to represent an abstract idea (the initial effort of personal growth). The context also links this to leaving the 'comfort zone' and overcoming the 'fear of change', which explains why it is the 'hardest'—it requires the most mental resolve to break the status quo.</p> <p>► <b>Step-by-step:</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Step 1: Identify that 'first step' is not literal but symbolises the initial effort for personal development.</li> <li>Step 2: Connect the 'hardness' of the step to the difficulty of leaving the comfort zone and overcoming the fear of change.</li> </ol> <p>[Ch 16: Believe in Yourself]</p>                                                                                                           | 2     |
| 12    | <p>Choose whether the given statements display: fact-opinion or cause-effect.</p> <p>(i) I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine.<br/>(ii) I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life.</p> <p><b>Answer: The given pair of statements displays a cause-effect relationship.</b></p> <p><b>Statement (i) states, "I was diagnosed with a tumour in my spine." This medical diagnosis serves as the cause or the initiating event.</b></p> <p><b>Statement (ii) states, "I had a surgery and was told that I would be bound to a wheelchair for the rest of my life." This represents the effect or the outcome of the previous event. Because the diagnosis directly led to the surgery and its resulting prognosis, the second statement is a direct consequence of the first. Furthermore, both statements are factual events rather than personal beliefs, eliminating the possibility of a fact-opinion relationship.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The statements display a cause-effect relationship because the diagnosis of a spinal tumour (statement i) is the cause that directly led to the surgery and the prognosis of being bound to a wheelchair (statement ii). Both statements are factual, so it is not a fact-opinion pair.</p> <p>► <b>Step-by-step:</b></p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Step 1: Analyze statement (i) as the initiating event (cause).</li> <li>Step 2: Analyze statement (ii) as the resulting outcome (effect).</li> <li>Step 3: Conclude that since one event directly led to the other, it is a cause-effect relationship.</li> </ol> <p>[Ch 9: The World of Limitless Possibilities]</p> | 2     |
| 13    | <p>What is the purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky?</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2     |



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|       | <p>Answer: <b>The purpose of likening the mother's gaze to the sky is to show that the mother's presence is vast, comforting, and protective. Just as the sky stretches endlessly and watches over the earth, the mother's love and watchful gaze surround the poet entirely.</b></p> <p><b>Furthermore, the sky acts as a symbolic extension of the mother's presence. Even though the poet cannot physically remember her, looking into the distant blue sky allows him to feel her stillness and warmth. This comparison beautifully connects nature with his deep emotional bond, making her presence felt universally and eternally through the calmness of the sky.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The context provides an MCQ option indicating that the sky is a 'symbolic extension of the mother's presence'. The poem's third stanza mentions the 'stillness of my mother's gaze' spreading 'all over the sky'. This comparison highlights the vast, protective, and eternal nature of a mother's love, using nature to evoke the feeling of her presence even in her physical absence.</p> <p>[Ch 8: I Cannot Remember My Mother]</p>                                                                                                           |       |
| 14    | <p>How do you think Khetaram would feel about taking up this challenging task every day?</p> <p>Answer: <b>Khetaram would likely feel a mix of physical exhaustion and dedication towards his duty. Walking 20 km in the scorching heat where the sands sizzle under his feet, carrying a mailbag weighing up to 28 kilos, is undeniably tiring. He himself admits that "Even a single delivery is tiring" during the summers.</b></p> <p><b>Despite this fatigue, he would feel a strong sense of readiness and pride in his role. This is evident when he enthusiastically says, "Main tayyar hoon" (I'm ready) before striding off to deliver the mail. His commitment to ensuring the mail reaches the border within 24 hours shows he embraces the challenge willingly.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The question asks for an inference about Khetaram's feelings based on the text. The text provides two contrasting pieces of evidence: the physical toll of the job (heat, distance, weight, 'tiring') and his enthusiastic willingness to do it ('Main tayyar hoon', striding off, ensuring 24-hour delivery). A complete answer must address both the physical fatigue and his dedicated, willing spirit.</p> <p>[Ch 13: Carrier of Words]</p> | 2     |
| 15    | <p>What might be Shruti's father's reaction? Why?</p> <p>Answer: <b>Shruti's father might react negatively and dismiss the idea of her participating in the fusion concert. He expresses strong disapproval of fusion music and remains adamant in his decision.</b></p> <p><b>He reacts this way because he firmly believes that Classical Hindustani music is the only kind of music an artist of worth should play. He considers playing the violin to Western tunes a desecration of the instrument and a betrayal of their family's traditional values.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2     |



| Q.NO. | QUESTIONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | MARKS |
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|       | <p>► <b>Why?</b> The question asks about Shruti's father's likely reaction, which refers to his initial response when she informs him about the concert. Based on the provided text, Nabin reacts negatively and dismisses the idea. The reason for this reaction is his strict adherence to traditional Classical Hindustani music and his view that fusion music desecrates the violin and goes against family tradition.</p> <p>[Ch 11: Twin Melodies]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |       |
| 16    | <p>What is the impact of the refrain, 'she's peerless, let's praise her!'?</p> <p>Answer: <b>The refrain 'she's peerless, let's praise her!' has a strong impact as it reinforces the central theme of the poem—India's unmatched greatness. By repeatedly asserting that the country is peerless, the poet emphasizes that India's natural beauty, spiritual heritage, and historical greatness have no equal anywhere on earth.</b></p> <p><b>Furthermore, the refrain creates a chant-like rhythm that adds to the lyrical quality of the poem. It acts as a powerful, unifying conclusion to the lists of India's glories, such as the mighty Himavanta, the generous Ganga, and the sacred Upanishads. Ultimately, it evokes a deep sense of admiration and pride, urging everyone to celebrate and honour this unparalleled land.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The question asks for the impact of the refrain. The context shows the refrain is a repeated assertion of India being 'peerless' (unmatched) and a call to 'praise' her. It ties together the examples of India's greatness (Himavanta, Ganga, Upanishads, etc.) mentioned in the stanzas. The context also mentions the poem has a 'measured, chant-like rhythm' and a tone of 'admiration and pride', which the refrain helps to build.</p> <p>[Ch 2: Bharat Our Land]</p> | 2     |
| 17    | <p>What is something that the elderly in your family cannot do easily but enjoy watching you do?</p> <p>Answer: <b>The elderly in my family cannot easily read and write. Like the grandmother in the text, they feel dependent and helpless because they are unable to read the alphabet or a novel on their own. Their inability to be literate makes them feel restricted.</b></p> <p><b>However, they enjoy watching me read and write fluently. Observing me do these things easily gives them joy and inspiration. It reinforces their belief that "for learning there is no age bar" and motivates them to seek the same independence and self-sufficiency that literacy brings.</b></p> <p>► <b>Why?</b> The question asks for a reflection based on the chapter's theme. The provided context highlights the grandmother's struggle with literacy (she couldn't read the alphabet or a novel) and her desire to learn from the narrator. Therefore, based strictly on the context, the activity the elderly cannot do easily is reading and writing, and they enjoy watching the younger generation do it, which inspires them to overcome their obstacles.</p> <p>[Ch 1: How I Taught My Grandmother to Read]</p>                                                                                                                   | 2     |

